

Approximation of Fixed Point Mappings

Pathak (2018) – Chapter 6e
Applications of Fixed Point Theorems

Lecture Notes

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Contents

- 1 Introduction to Fixed Point Approximation
- 2 Contraction Mapping Theorem
- 3 Convergence Analysis
- 4 Iterative Methods for Finding Fixed Points
- 5 Applications to Differential Equations
- 6 Applications to Integral Equations
- 7 Numerical Examples and Convergence Rates
- 8 Advanced Topics
- 9 Summary and Applications

Fixed Point Mappings and Iteration I

Definition (Fixed Point)

Let $(X, \|\cdot\|)$ be a Banach space and $T : D \subseteq X \rightarrow X$ be a mapping. A point $x^* \in D$ is called a **fixed point** of T if

$$T(x^*) = x^*.$$

Definition (Fixed Point Approximation)

Given a mapping T with a fixed point x^* , an **approximation sequence** $\{x_n\}$ is defined recursively by

$$x_{n+1} = T(x_n), \quad n = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

where $x_0 \in D$ is an initial guess.

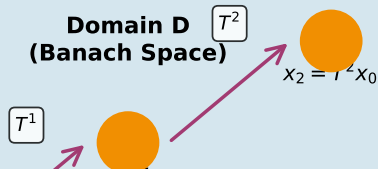
Fixed Point Mappings and Iteration II

Theorem (Existence and Uniqueness)

If $T : D \rightarrow D$ is a continuous mapping on a compact set D in a Banach space, then T has at least one fixed point.

Fixed Point Mappings and Iteration III

Fixed Point Mapping: Sequence Generation



Basic Iterative Scheme

Picard Iteration

The most basic approach to approximate a fixed point is the Picard iteration:

$$x_{n+1} = T(x_n), \quad n = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

Key Questions:

- 1 Does the sequence $\{x_n\}$ converge?
- 2 If it converges, does it converge to a fixed point?
- 3 What is the rate of convergence?
- 4 How many iterations are needed for a desired accuracy?

The convergence depends on properties of T (continuity, contractiveness, etc.) and the structure of the domain D .

Contraction Mappings

Definition (Contraction Mapping)

A mapping $T : D \subseteq X \rightarrow X$ is a **contraction mapping** (or λ -contraction) if there exists a constant $0 \leq \lambda < 1$ such that

$$\|T(x) - T(y)\| \leq \lambda \|x - y\| \quad \text{for all } x, y \in D.$$

The constant λ is called the **contraction rate**.

Properties

Every contraction is continuous.

A contraction is uniformly continuous.

The contraction rate measures how fast distances shrink.

Banach Contraction Mapping Theorem

Theorem (Banach (1922))

Let $(X, \|\cdot\|)$ be a complete metric space and $T : X \rightarrow X$ be a contraction mapping with contraction rate $0 \leq \lambda < 1$. Then:

- 1 T has a unique fixed point $x^* \in X$.
- 2 For any initial point $x_0 \in X$, the sequence $\{x_n\}$ defined by $x_{n+1} = T(x_n)$ converges to x^* .
- 3 The error estimate is:

$$\|x_n - x^*\| \leq \lambda^n \|x_0 - x^*\|.$$

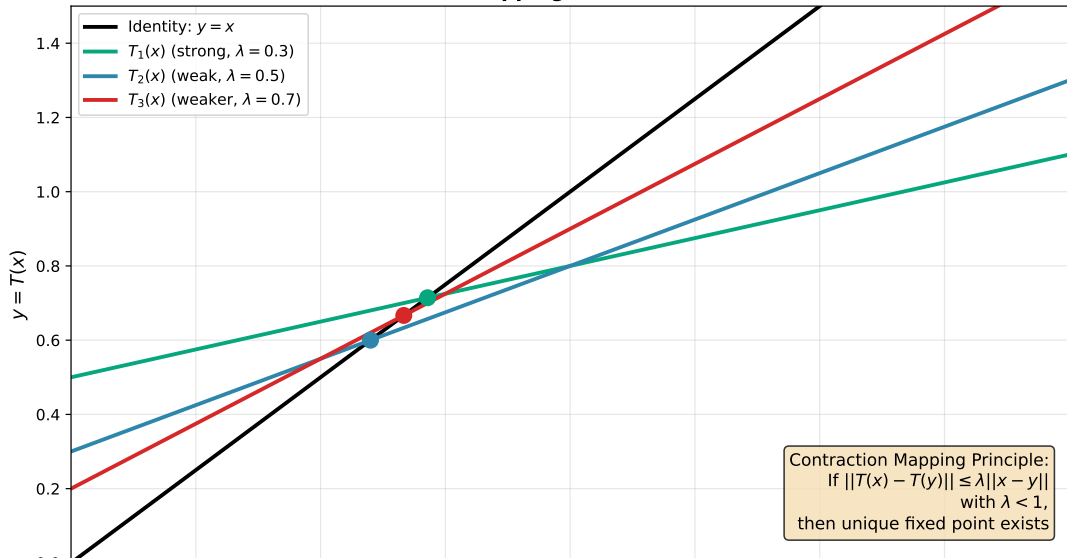
Corollary (A Priori Error Bound)

Before computing x_n , we can estimate:

$$\|x_n - x^*\| \leq \frac{\lambda^n}{1 - \lambda} \|x_1 - x_0\|.$$

Visual Illustration of Contraction Mappings

Contraction Mappings with Different Rates



Linear and Nonlinear Convergence I

Definition (Order of Convergence)

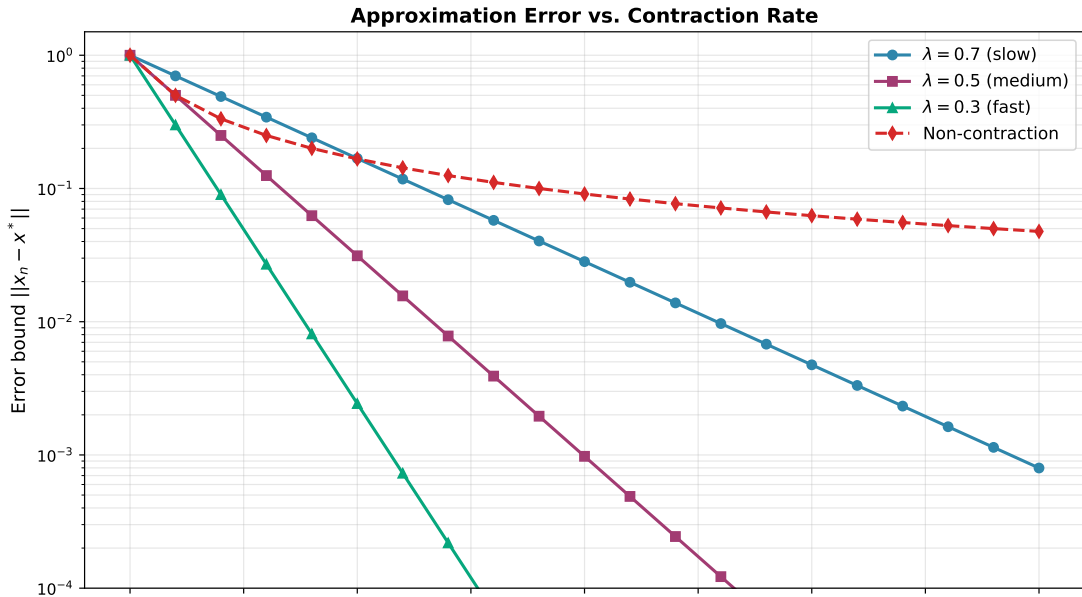
A sequence $\{x_n\}$ converges to x^* with **order** p if:

$$\|x_{n+1} - x^*\| \leq C \|x_n - x^*\|^p$$

for some constant $C > 0$ and all n sufficiently large.

- **Linear convergence:** $p = 1$ with $0 < C < 1$
- **Superlinear convergence:** $p = 1$ with $C = 0$
- **Quadratic convergence:** $p = 2$
- **Superquadratic convergence:** $p > 2$

Linear and Nonlinear Convergence II



Error Bounds and Stopping Criteria

Residual Error

At iteration m , define the residual error:

$$R_m = \|x_{m+1} - T(x_m)\| = \|x_{m+1} - x_{m+1}\| = 0 \quad (\text{by construction})$$

More generally, we measure:

$$R_m = \|F(x_m)\|$$

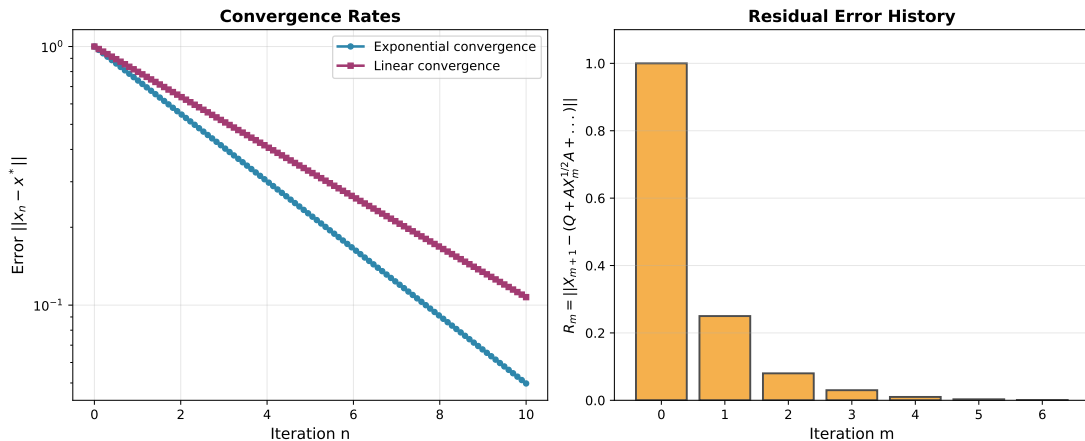
where $F(x) = x - T(x)$ is the **residual operator**.

Stopping Criteria

Common criteria to terminate iteration:

- ① $\|x_{n+1} - x_n\| < \epsilon$ (successive approximation)
- ② $\|F(x_n)\| < \epsilon$ (residual)
- ③ $n > N_{\max}$ (maximum iterations)
- ④ Relative error: $\frac{\|x_{n+1} - x_n\|}{\|x_{n+1}\|} < \epsilon_{\text{rel}}$

Example: Convergence Behavior



The left panel shows exponential vs. linear convergence rates. The right panel displays residual error history over iterations.

Mann Iteration

Definition (Mann Iteration (1953))

For a mapping $T : D \rightarrow D$, the Mann iteration is defined by:

$$x_{n+1} = (1 - \alpha_n)x_n + \alpha_n T(x_n), \quad n = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

where $\{\alpha_n\}$ is a sequence of parameters with $0 \leq \alpha_n \leq 1$.

Properties

When $\alpha_n = 1$: recovers Picard iteration.

When $0 < \alpha_n < 1$: provides convex combination (damping).

Choice of $\{\alpha_n\}$ affects convergence:

- Constant $\alpha_n = \alpha$: easier analysis
- Variable $\{\alpha_n\}$: may accelerate convergence

Theorem (Convergence of Mann Iteration)

Mann Iteration Example

Python Implementation

```
1 import numpy as np
2
3 def mann_iteration(T, x0, alpha=0.5, max_iter=100, tol=1e-8):
4     """Mann iteration for fixed point approximation"""
5     x = x0
6     history = [x]
7
8     for n in range(max_iter):
9         T_x = T(x)
10        x_new = (1 - alpha) * x + alpha * T_x
11
12        if np.linalg.norm(x_new - x) < tol:
13            print(f"Converged in {n+1} iterations")
14            break
15
16        x = x_new
17        history.append(x)
18
19    return x, np.array(history)
20
21 # Example:  $T(x) = 0.5x + 0.3\sin(x)$ 
22 T = lambda x: 0.5*x + 0.3*np.sin(x)
23 x_fixed, history = mann_iteration(T, x0=0.0)
```

Ishikawa Iteration

Definition (Ishikawa Iteration (1974))

The Ishikawa iteration is a two-step scheme:

$$y_n = (1 - \beta_n)x_n + \beta_n T(x_n), \quad (1)$$

$$x_{n+1} = (1 - \alpha_n)x_n + \alpha_n T(y_n), \quad (2)$$

where $\{\alpha_n\}$ and $\{\beta_n\}$ are parameter sequences.

Properties

Generalizes Mann iteration (recovers it when $\beta_n = 0$).

Potential for faster convergence with two parameters.

More computational cost (two applications of T per iteration).

Comparison of Methods

Method	Iterations	Evaluations of T
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Noor Iteration

Definition (Noor Iteration (1997))

A three-step iteration scheme:

$$y_n = (1 - \beta_n)x_n + \beta_n T(x_n), \quad (3)$$

$$z_n = (1 - \gamma_n)y_n + \gamma_n T(y_n), \quad (4)$$

$$x_{n+1} = (1 - \alpha_n)z_n + \alpha_n T(z_n), \quad (5)$$

Properties

Potentially faster convergence with three parameters.

Increased computational cost (3 evaluations of T per iteration).

Useful for certain nonlinear operators and nonexpansive mappings.

Two-Point Boundary Value Problems I

Problem

Consider the boundary value problem:

$$x''(t) = f(t, x(t), x'(t)), \quad 0 \leq t \leq T, \quad (6)$$

$$x(0) = \alpha, \quad x(T) = \beta. \quad (7)$$

Two-Point Boundary Value Problems II

Solution

Transform to an integral equation:

$$x(t) = \alpha + \frac{(\beta - \alpha)t}{T} - \int_0^T G(t, s) f(s, x(s), x'(s)) ds,$$

where $G(t, s)$ is the Green's function:

$$G(t, s) = \begin{cases} \frac{s(T-t)}{T} & 0 \leq s \leq t \leq T \\ \frac{t(T-s)}{T} & 0 \leq t \leq s \leq T \end{cases}$$

Two-Point Boundary Value Problems III

Fixed Point Formulation

Define the operator $F : C^1[0, T] \rightarrow C^1[0, T]$ by:

$$(Fx)(t) = \alpha + \frac{(\beta - \alpha)t}{T} - \int_0^T G(t, s)f(s, x(s), x'(s)) ds.$$

The boundary value problem solution is a fixed point of F :

$$F(x) = x \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad x \text{ solves the BVP.}$$

Theorem

Under appropriate boundedness and continuity conditions on f and the Green's function, F is continuous and compact. By Schauder's fixed point theorem, F has at least one fixed point.

Periodic Solution Problem

Problem

Find periodic solutions to:

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = f(t, x(t)), \quad x(0) = x(p), \quad (8)$$

where $p > 0$ is the period and $f(t, x)$ is periodic in t with period p .

Solution

Define the operator $F : C[0, p] \rightarrow C[0, p]$ by:

$$(Fx)(t) = x_0 + \int_0^t f(s, x(s)) ds,$$

where the periodicity condition imposes additional constraints.

The Poincaré operator (period map) can be analyzed to show existence of periodic solutions via fixed point theory.

Hammerstein Integral Equations

Definition (Hammerstein Equation)

An equation of the form:

$$x(t) = \lambda \int_a^b K(t, s) f(s, x(s)) ds + g(t),$$

where:

- $K(t, s)$ is the kernel (typically continuous)
- $f(s, x)$ is a nonlinearity
- λ is a parameter
- $g(t)$ is a given function

Fixed Point Formulation

The Hammerstein equation can be written as a fixed point problem:

$$x = T(x),$$

Hammerstein Equation: Numerical Example

Example Setup

Consider:

$$x(t) = \lambda \int_0^1 (t + s) \exp(-x(s)) ds + t$$

Python Solution

```
1 from scipy.integrate import quad
2
3 def hammerstein_operator(x_func, lam=0.5):
4     """Hammerstein operator application"""
5     def T(t):
6         integrand = lambda s: (t + s) * np.exp(-x_func(s))
7         result, _ = quad(integrand, 0, 1)
8         return lam * result + t
9     return T
10
11 # Fixed point iteration
12 def solve_hammerstein(lam, max_iter=50):
13     # Start with x_0(t) = t
14     x = lambda t: t
15
```

Urysohn Integral Equations

Definition (Urysohn Equation)

An equation of the form:

$$x(t) = \int_{\Omega} f(t, s, x(s)) ds,$$

where $f : \Omega \times \Omega \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a given kernel.

The Hammerstein equation is a special case where $f(t, s, x) = K(t, s)g(x)$.

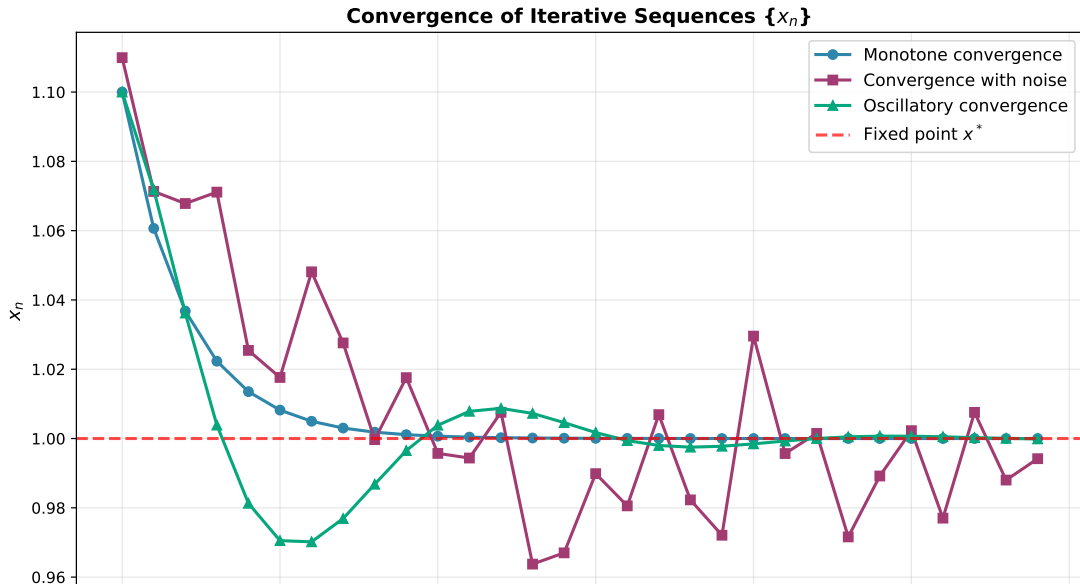
Theorem (Existence of Solutions)

If:

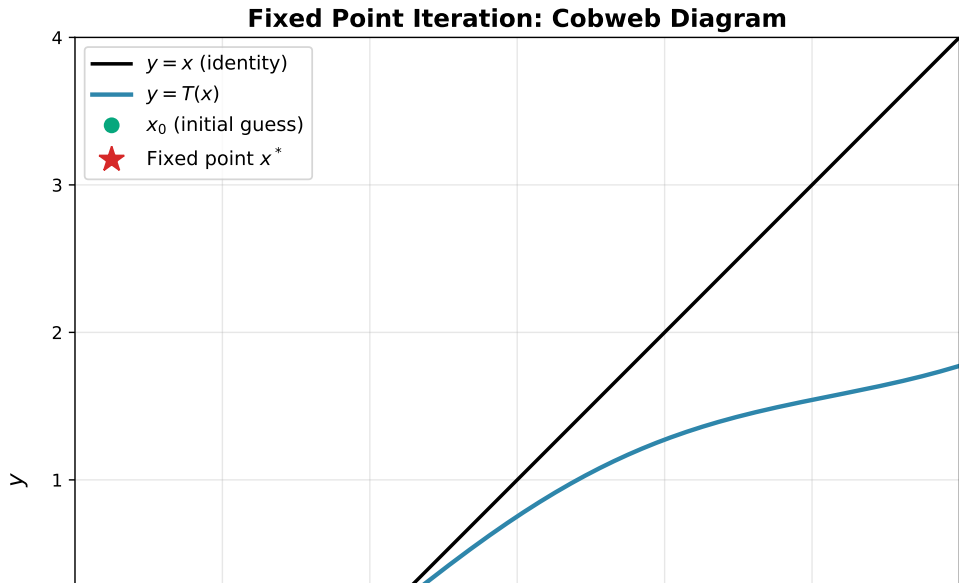
- 1 f is continuous on $\Omega \times \Omega \times \mathbb{R}$,
- 2 f satisfies a Lipschitz condition in the third variable,
- 3 $\int_{\Omega} |f(t, s, 0)| ds \leq M$ for some constant M ,

then the Urysohn equation has at least one solution in $C(\Omega)$.

Sequence Convergence Behaviors



Fixed Point Iteration Visualization



Computational Example: Matrix Fixed Point

Problem

Solve $X = Q + AX^{1/2}A^* + BX^{-1}B^*$ using Picard iteration.

```
1 import numpy as np
2 from scipy.linalg import sqrtm
3
4 def matrix_fixed_point(Q, A, B, X0, max_iter=100, tol=1e-8):
5     """Solve matrix fixed point equation iteratively"""
6     X = X0.copy()
7
8     for m in range(max_iter):
9         X_sqrt = sqrtm(X)
10        X_inv = np.linalg.inv(X)
11
12        # Picard step:  $X_{m+1} = T(X_m)$ 
13        X_new = Q + A @ X_sqrt @ A.T + B @ X_inv @ B.T
14
15        # Compute residual
16        residual = np.linalg.norm(X_new - X)
17
18        if residual < tol:
19            print(f"Converged in {m+1} iterations")
20            return X_new
```

Nonexpansive Mappings

Definition (Nonexpansive Mapping)

A mapping $T : D \rightarrow X$ is **nonexpansive** if:

$$\|T(x) - T(y)\| \leq \|x - y\| \quad \text{for all } x, y \in D.$$

Key difference from contractions:

- Nonexpansive: contraction rate $\lambda = 1$ (not strictly less than 1).
- Banach theorem does not directly apply!
- Requires additional structure (e.g., compactness, normal structure).

Theorem (Schauder Fixed Point Theorem)

If $T : K \rightarrow K$ is continuous and K is a nonempty compact convex subset of a Banach space, then T has a fixed point in K .

Quasi-Nonexpansive Mappings

Definition (Quasi-Nonexpansive)

A mapping T is quasi-nonexpansive if it has a fixed point x^* and:

$$\|T(x) - x^*\| \leq \|x - x^*\| \quad \text{for all } x \in D.$$

Properties

Weaker than nonexpansive (doesn't require $\|T(x) - T(y)\| \leq \|x - y\|$ for all x, y).

Guarantees monotone convergence to the fixed point.

Examples: projections onto closed convex sets.

Theorem

If T is quasi-nonexpansive and Mann iteration is used with appropriate parameters $\{\alpha_n\}$, then $\{x_n\}$ converges to the fixed point.

Hybrid Methods and Operator Splitting

Motivation

For complex operators $T = T_1 + T_2$ or $T = T_1 \circ T_2$, apply iterations to individual components.

Definition (Operator Splitting)

Instead of:

$$x_{n+1} = T(x_n),$$

use:

$$x_{n+1} = T_1(T_2(x_n)), \quad (\text{Alternating}) \tag{9}$$

$$x_{n+1} = \lambda T_1(x_n) + (1 - \lambda) T_2(x_n), \quad (\text{Convex combination}) \tag{10}$$

Applications

Useful for:

- Proximal operator splitting in optimization.

Summary of Key Results

- ① **Banach Contraction Principle:** λ -contractions have unique fixed points reachable by Picard iteration with exponential convergence.
- ② **Iterative Methods:** Mann, Ishikawa, and Noor iterations generalize Picard iteration with damping parameters for improved convergence.
- ③ **Differential Equations:** Boundary value and periodic solution problems reduce to fixed point equations via Green's functions.
- ④ **Integral Equations:** Hammerstein and Urysohn equations are fixed point problems in function spaces.
- ⑤ **Nonexpansive and Quasi-Nonexpansive:** Extended theory for mappings not satisfying strict contractiveness.

Applications Across Disciplines

Numerical Analysis

- Solving nonlinear equations (Newton's method, fixed point iteration)
- Eigenvalue problems and spectral computations
- Matrix equations and tensor computations

Optimization

- Proximal methods and forward-backward splitting
- Alternating direction method of multipliers (ADMM)
- Stochastic gradient descent and online learning

Engineering and Physics

- Control system design and feedback loops
- Chemical reactor models
- Fluid dynamics and partial differential equations

Open Problems and Future Directions

- 1 **Acceleration Techniques:** How to enhance convergence rates using preprocessing, extrapolation, or Krylov subspace methods?
- 2 **Nonlinear Operators:** Theory for more general nonlinear structures beyond contractions and nonexpansive mappings.
- 3 **Stochastic Algorithms:** Convergence analysis for randomized and stochastic fixed point iterations.
- 4 **Distributed Computing:** Fixed point methods for parallel and distributed computing in large-scale problems.
- 5 **Machine Learning:** Applications to deep learning training algorithms and neural network optimization.

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